A Practical 90-Day Onboarding Plan for New Employees

The first three months decide whether a new hire becomes a committed team member or an early resignation. Good onboarding is less about a welcome lunch and more about clarity: what is expected, who to ask and how success will be measured.

Review date: _____ Reviewed by: _____

Key points

• Onboarding starts before day one, with signed paperwork and a ready workstation.

• Clear 30, 60 and 90 day goals give new hires something concrete to aim for.

• Regular check-ins catch small problems before they become resignations.

Before day one

Send the signed contract, a short welcome note and the first week schedule in advance. Few things undermine a new hire's confidence like arriving to find no desk and no login.

- [ ] Signed contract and statutory registration details collected
- [ ] Equipment, email and system access prepared
- [ ] Line manager and a buddy named
- [ ] First-week schedule shared

The first week

Focus on belonging and the basics. Introduce the team, explain what the organisation does and how it makes money, walk through the handbook and key policies, and agree the first set of tasks. Give the new hire real work early, with support, so they feel useful quickly.

Goals for days 30, 60 and 90

- [ ] By day 30: understands the role, the team and the main processes, and has completed early tasks with support
- [ ] By day 60: working more independently and contributing to team goals
- [ ] By day 90: owning agreed responsibilities, with a formal conversation about performance and development

Check-ins that matter

Hold a short one-to-one every week for the first month, then every two weeks. Ask what is going well, what is confusing and what support is missing. Write down what you agree, and follow through on it.

Common mistakes

- [ ] Leaving onboarding to whoever happens to have time
- [ ] Overloading the first week with information and no real work
- [ ] Skipping the probation review

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